What to know about Rosa Parks

Friday 29 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 4 | HUM-GROW-S1-W04

Learning outcome: Evaluate the significance of a person who created change.

Rosa Parks lived from 1913 to 2005. She worked for civil rights before and after the Montgomery bus boycott. Her arrest on 1 December 1955 helped prompt the protest. Many people kept it going. A separate court case helped change bus law. Her part must be judged within that shared work.

Date	What happened
1943	Parks became secretary of a local civil rights group.
1 December 1955	Her refusal and arrest helped prompt the boycott.
5 December 1955	The bus boycott began. Many people sustained it.
1956	A separate court case challenged bus segregation. Parks was not a plaintiff.
21 December 1956	People returned to buses after the court order.
1965–1988	Parks worked in a member of Congress's Detroit office.
1999 and 2013	A medal and later a statue show public recognition.

A reasoned view

Use all four tests. A high score needs a clear reason and a limit. Fame alone does not prove every claim. Parks did not act alone. Bus law changed, but racism did not end.

Historians and museum staff weigh evidence to explain why people matter.